



HANDS WITH HEART FOUNDATION | 2024 ANNUAL REPORT

2024

Growing Through Challenge

Expanding our reach, learning from pressure, and strengthening the foundations of disability care

1,326

 UNIQUE
BENEFICIARIES

1,849

CLINICAL SESSIONS

21

 MISSIONS /
ACTIVITIES

€268,110

DIRECT VALUE

Executive Summary

2024 in one sentence

In 2024, Hands With Heart Foundation grew through challenge: expanding clinical care across humanitarian missions, Ukraine-related rehabilitation, adaptive surfing, and academic education while learning that stronger fundraising, communication, and organisational systems are essential for sustainable growth.

Metric	2024 result
Official income	€63,939.15
Direct value generated	€268,110
Value per €1 income	€4.19
Unique beneficiaries	1,326
Clinical sessions	1,849
Missions / activities	21
Volunteers and clinical team members	83
Conservative capacity-building participants	50

THE ANNUAL REPORT FOLLOWS A SIMPLE PUBLIC LOGIC

What problem exists; what HwH did; who benefited; what value was generated; why it matters; what was learned; what comes next; and what support is needed.

Letter from the President

When I look back at 2024, I see a year that tested us and strengthened us at the same time. It was a year of new doors, new responsibilities, and difficult realities. Above all, it was the year in which Ukraine showed us that the experience we had built over many years was preparing us for a deeper level of clinical and human need.

Hands With Heart began by offering free healthcare to children and adults with disabilities in under-resourced communities. We learned from Bali, Costa Rica, Argentina, adaptive surfing, and many families who trusted us with their children. In 2024, that accumulated experience became a form of readiness.

In Ukraine, we treated soldiers with amputations, people living with war-related disability, children whose access to healthcare had been affected by the invasion, and combat medics through REpower recovery programmes. Some of the people we met carried not only physical injury, but also profound emotional trauma. This changed the way we understood our work.

“Relieving pain is not enough. We must also be willing to be present where it hurts most. That is why we are in Ukraine.”

2024 also opened important institutional pathways. After years of investing in the United States, our presence at the American Academy of Osteopathy Annual Convocation began to generate real interest. Volunteers from Western University of Health Sciences joined us, and we created an additional Costa Rica mission to make that possible. This later helped prepare the ground for a formal university agreement.

The year also brought recognition in adaptive surfing, university education, and professional training. But it was not an easy year. We struggled with communication, volunteer recruitment, high travel costs, limited funding, and external partners who did not always provide the operational support we expected. These challenges did not stop the work, but they made clear what we must build next.

This report is therefore not only a record of activity. It is a record of growth under pressure. It shows that HwH can respond to complex disability, war injury, trauma, and exclusion. It also shows that if we want to continue responsibly, we need stronger financial partners, better communication systems, and a wider operational team.

01

The Problem HwH Responds To

Disability is universal, but the way society responds to disability is shaped by poverty, geography, culture, war, stigma, and access to healthcare. Across different communities, HwH sees a repeated pattern: children and adults with disabilities are often under-treated, hidden, excluded, or unsupported by the systems around them.

In 2024, this problem appeared in very different settings: children with disabilities in Bali, Indigenous communities in Costa Rica, war-related disability in Ukraine, adaptive athletes requiring specialised support, and Spanish military personnel involved in the Valencia DANA flood response.

HWH POSITION

Hands With Heart does not approach communities by imposing an external worldview. The Foundation seeks first to understand how each community perceives disability, pain, trauma, and care, then adds healthcare, training, and support in a culturally respectful way.

02

Mission, Vision, and Values

Area	Statement
Mission	To provide free healthcare for underprivileged children and adults with disabilities who have zero or limited access to health support due to socioeconomic, cultural, religious, or geographical circumstances.
Vision	To become a recognised humanitarian reference for disability support, so that communities know where to seek healthcare, psychological, educational, cultural, financial, and practical assistance.
Core values	Human dignity; cultural humility; commitment through action; capacity building; transparency; and long-term trust.

03

HwH Operating Principles

Principle	Meaning
Care is free for beneficiaries	HwH does not charge children, adults, families, or communities for the healthcare delivered during humanitarian missions.
Repeated care, not one-off charity	People with complex disabilities often need continuity, trust, follow-up, and repeated intervention.
Dignity first, then care	The person's dignity is inherent. HwH seeks to understand the person, family, and cultural context before offering care.
Empowering communities from within	HwH works alongside local therapists, families, caregivers, institutions, and community members so knowledge and confidence grow inside the community itself.
Honest impact. Clearly reported.	HwH uses conservative, understandable reporting and distinguishes between beneficiaries, sessions, direct value, and broader intangible impact.
Making invisible realities visible	HwH shares real stories, images, and testimonies to raise awareness of realities many people may never otherwise see, with consent and respect.

04

HwH Programmatic Pillars

Pillar	How it works in practice
Free specialised disability care	Clinical care is provided without charging beneficiaries, especially where poverty, geography, stigma, or war restrict access.
Repeated care for complex needs	HwH measures impact through both beneficiaries and sessions because complex disability often requires repeated care.
Home visits and access-based care	When people cannot reach care, HwH teams go to homes, institutions, remote territories, or difficult environments.
Capacity building	The Foundation trains local therapists, families, caregivers, students, and institutions to strengthen continuity beyond mission days.
Cultural humility	HwH seeks to understand local beliefs and realities before acting, so support is respectful and not imposed.
Institutional strengthening	HwH develops relationships with universities, schools, community organisations, surf associations, and rehabilitation partners.
Disability across contexts	HwH works with disability through humanitarian care, war injury, Indigenous access, children's institutions, adaptive sport, and emergency response.

05

2024 at a Glance

Metric	2024 result
Unique beneficiaries treated	1,326
Clinical sessions delivered	1,849
Missions / activities	21
Volunteers and clinical team members	83
Conservative capacity-building participants	50
Internal local participants recorded	71
Direct measurable value generated	€268,110
Official income reported in Spanish annual accounts	€63,939.15

Metric	2024 result
Value generated per €1 of official income	€4.19
Countries / programmes with recorded activity	Bali, Costa Rica, Ukraine, REpower, Adaptive Surfing, Argentina / Chaco, Spain / Valencia DANA

Beneficiaries vs. Sessions: Why Both Numbers Matter

STRATEGIC PRINCIPLE: REPEATED CARE, NOT ONE-OFF CHARITY

HwH distinguishes between unique beneficiaries and total clinical sessions because many children and adults served by the Foundation live with severe or complex disabilities. In this context, impact is not measured only by how many people are seen once. It is also measured by how consistently care returns to those who need it most.

Programme	Unique beneficiaries	Clinical sessions	Interpretation
Bali	166	376	Children and adults with complex disability needs received repeated mission-based care.
Costa Rica	379	402	Accessible Cartago care combined with Bribri/Talamanca access work.
Ukraine inside Ukraine	190	276	Children with disabilities and soldiers with amputations or war-related disability.
REpower combat medics abroad	156	167	Recovery care for Ukrainian combat medics outside Ukraine.
Adaptive Surfing	263	456	Specialised healthcare for adaptive surfing athletes across international events.
Argentina / Chaco	118	118	Mission-based care in Chaco.
Spain / Valencia DANA	54	54	Support for military personnel involved in flood response.
Total	1,326	1,849	The difference between beneficiaries and sessions reflects repeated care and continuity.

A higher number of sessions than beneficiaries is not duplication. It reflects clinical depth. Many beneficiaries do not need one isolated treatment; they need continuity, repetition, adjustment, trust, and follow-up.

06

How Direct Value Was Calculated

The value calculations in this report use a conservative replacement-value approach. This estimates what the delivered care, training, or support would reasonably have cost if beneficiaries, communities, institutions, or organisers had needed to pay for equivalent services.

The calculation is not presented as profit, commercial billing, or total social return. It is a transparent way to translate donated healthcare and support into measurable value.

Value block	Included in direct value?	Method
Clinical sessions	Yes	Number of sessions x agreed replacement value per session
Home visits	Yes	Session value adjusted for access and logistical difficulty
Capacity building	Yes	Conservative participants x hours x blended training value
Professional courses where participants paid	No	Reported separately as educational impact
Volunteer education	Reported separately	Not included in the main community-value multiplier to avoid double counting
Volunteer fees	No	Treated as official income / operational support, not direct community value

Context	Value per session
Bali specialised disability care	€100 standard / €125 home visit
Costa Rica accessible care	€75
Costa Rica Bribri/Talamanca home visit	€155
Ukraine children with disabilities inside Ukraine	€150
Ukraine soldiers with amputations or war-related disability	€200
REpower Ukrainian combat medics treated abroad	€150
Adaptive surfing professional athletes	€150
Argentina / Chaco	€125
Spain / Valencia DANA support	€75

07

Programme Results by Country and Area

Bali, Indonesia

Bali remained a central programme area in 2024, combining direct clinical care, home visits, local education, and university engagement. The future Hands With Heart Centre for Children with Disabilities in Bali was already beginning to emerge as a strategic possibility.

Metric	2024 result
Unique beneficiaries	166
Clinical sessions	376
Home-visit sessions	90
Standard / institution sessions	286
Local participants recorded	22
Direct value generated	€39,850

Costa Rica

Costa Rica combined accessible care in Cartago with Bribri/Talamanca access work. The year showed the value of repeated presence but also the difficulty of sustaining missions when travel costs and volunteer recruitment are challenging.

Metric	2024 result
Unique beneficiaries	379
Clinical sessions	402
Cartago sessions	375
Bribri/Talamanca home visits	27
Local participants recorded	20
Direct value generated	€32,310

Ukraine and REpower

Ukraine became the emotional and clinical centre of 2024. HwH supported soldiers with amputations and war-related disability, children with disabilities affected by the war, and Ukrainian combat medics through REpower recovery programmes abroad.

Area	Beneficiaries	Sessions	Direct value
Ukraine inside Ukraine	190	276	€52,450
REpower combat medics abroad	156	167	€25,050
Total Ukraine-related work	346	443	€77,500

LEARNING TO SUPPORT THE NERVOUS SYSTEM, NOT ONLY THE BODY

Ukraine and REpower deepened HwH's understanding of trauma-informed care. Treating combat medics, including some who had experienced captivity, and soldiers with severe amputations showed that care could not focus only on muscles, scars, joints, or pain. It also required attention to regulation, safety, presence, and co-regulation.

Adaptive Surfing

In 2024, HwH became an official partner of the International Surfing Association and expanded its presence in adaptive surfing. This was a strategic breakthrough, although operational support did not always match expectations.

Event / area	Beneficiaries	Sessions	Direct value
Australia / Byron Bay	26	35	€5,250
Hawaii	59	107	€16,050
Costa Rica Surf Adaptado	55	103	€15,450
USA / Stoke for Life	45	125	€18,750
USA / ISA	78	86	€12,900
Total	263	456	€68,400

Argentina / Chaco

Argentina / Chaco was active in 2024, with 118 sessions delivered during the June mission.

Metric	2024 result
Unique beneficiaries	118
Clinical sessions	118
Direct value generated	€14,750

Spain / Valencia DANA

In December 2024, HwH supported Spanish military personnel involved in the response and clean-up after the Valencia DANA floods.

Metric	2024 result
Unique beneficiaries	54
Clinical sessions	54
Direct value generated	€4,050

Education and Academic Development

In 2024, HwH strengthened its role as an educational and academic reference within the international osteopathic community and among future healthcare professionals.

Education area	Activity	Participants
University-based education	Dhyana Pura University, Bali - physiotherapy students	nearly 100
University-based education	Putra Malaysia University workshop in Bali - medical students	18
University-based education	Southern Cross University, Australia - osteopathic medicine students	46
Postgraduate / professional training	Australia osteopathic course	approx. 30
Postgraduate / professional training	Barcelona course, May 2024	approx. 18
International professional visibility	American Academy of Osteopathy Annual Convocation - student and professional agenda talks/workshops	not counted as university education

08

Direct Value Generated in 2024

Programme / value block	Direct value generated
Bali	€39,850
Costa Rica	€32,310
Ukraine inside Ukraine	€52,450
REpower	€25,050
Adaptive Surfing	€68,400
Argentina / Chaco	€14,750

Programme / value block	Direct value generated
Spain / Valencia DANA	€4,050
Clinical / mission value subtotal	€236,860
Capacity-building value	€31,250
Total Direct Value Generated	€268,110

INTERPRETATION

The €268,110 figure represents direct measurable value generated through free clinical care, home visits, mission-based care, and conservative capacity-building valuation. It does not include broader intangible effects such as stigma reduction, trust-building, caregiver confidence, academic visibility, or the long-term multiplier effect of repeated care.

Internal mission records identified 71 local participants connected to capacity-building activities in 2024. For public valuation, HwH uses a more conservative figure of 50 participants to avoid overstating impact and to keep the calculation cautious and defensible.

09

Financial Transparency

Financial figures in this section are based on the official documents provided for 2024: the Spanish annual accounts for HwH's Spanish association and the US Form 990-EZ for Hands With Heart Foundation. The direct value calculation uses euros and compares against the official Spanish income figure to avoid mixing currencies.

Official financial figure	Amount
Income from own activity / donations and legacies - Spain annual accounts	€63,939.15
Total calculated expenses - Spain annual accounts	€55,094.44
Surplus for the year - Spain annual accounts	€8,844.71
Total revenue - US Form 990-EZ	\$63,939
Total expenses - US Form 990-EZ	\$55,094
Excess for the year - US Form 990-EZ	\$8,845

Impact comparison	Amount
Official income used for euro comparison	€63,939.15
Estimated direct value generated	€268,110

Impact comparison	Amount
Estimated value generated per €1 of official income	€4.19

FINANCIAL INTERPRETATION

In 2024, every €1 of official income was transformed into approximately €4.19 of direct measurable value. This ratio does not claim total social return on investment; it only compares official income with conservative replacement-value estimates for direct services and support delivered.

Although HwH does not have a salaried staff structure, the Foundation still carries essential service-based operating costs, including accounting, legal, IT, website, marketing, communication, and compliance support. These costs are reflected within the official annual accounts, particularly under external services rather than salaries.

10

Operational Transparency and Organisational Learning

Area	Learning
Ukraine	Clinically central and emotionally significant, but too dependent on Jorge alone for delivery and continuity.
REpower	Valuable support for Ukrainian combat medics; showed the need to build a wider specialist trauma-informed team.
Adaptive Surfing	Official recognition increased, but operational support did not always match expectations.
Bali	Strategically central, with early roadmap thinking toward a future permanent centre.
Costa Rica	High ethical and access value, but financially and logistically demanding.
Communication	Still under development; strong footage existed, but the structure to transform it into consistent public awareness was not yet mature.
Funding	Field impact was stronger than the funding structure. Long-term financial partners were needed.

11

What HwH Did Well in 2024

- Delivered 1,849 clinical sessions to 1,326 unique beneficiaries across 21 missions and activities.
- Generated an estimated €268,110 in direct measurable value from €63,939.15 of official income.

- Mobilised 83 volunteers and clinical team members across humanitarian, war-related, adaptive sport, academic, and emergency-response contexts.
- Began a breakthrough in the United States after years of investing in the American osteopathic community, including Western University of Health Sciences volunteers.
- Became an official partner of the International Surfing Association and expanded support within the adaptive surfing ecosystem.
- Demonstrated clinical readiness for highly complex Ukraine-related cases involving amputation, trauma, dysregulation, and war-related disability.
- Strengthened educational visibility through university workshops, postgraduate courses, and professional presentations.
- Responded to the Spain / Valencia DANA context by supporting military personnel involved in the flood response.

12

What HwH Must Improve

- Build a stronger and more stable fundraising structure, with long-term financial partners rather than fragile or uncertain support.
- Strengthen communication capacity so field work, footage, stories, and impact data can be transformed into consistent public awareness and donor engagement.
- Reduce dependency on Jorge for Ukraine and REpower by developing a wider specialist clinical team.
- Secure written operational commitments from external partners before events, especially when travel and accommodation support is expected.
- Improve volunteer recruitment strategies, especially when flight costs make participation harder.
- Develop programme-level budgets so each activity area can be planned, funded, and evaluated more clearly.
- Continue preparing governance, safeguarding, reporting, and operational systems before moving toward a permanent Bali centre.

13

The Community Behind HwH

The 2024 impact was made possible by a broad community of people and institutions who contributed time, knowledge, trust, access, and care. HwH is not only a foundation delivering missions; it is a growing network of volunteers, clinicians, local partners, universities, families, adaptive athletes, and supporters who choose to respond.

Community group	Contribution in 2024
Volunteers and clinical team members	83 people contributed across missions, adaptive sport, Ukraine, REpower, education, and emergency response.

Community group	Contribution in 2024
Local therapists, caregivers, and institutions	Supported continuity, access, translation, care environments, and capacity building.
Universities	Dhyana Pura University, Putra Malaysia University, Southern Cross University, and Western University pathways supported education and institutional visibility.
Adaptive surfing community	ISA, event organisers, local volunteers, and athletes helped position HwH within the adaptive sport ecosystem.
Supporters and donors	Kept the organisation active despite the absence of major grants or stable institutional sponsorship in 2024.

14

Future Direction: From Missions Toward a Permanent Bali Roadmap

In 2024, HwH was already beginning to shape the roadmap toward a future Hands With Heart Centre for Children with Disabilities in Bali. The name and concept were still evolving, but the strategic direction was becoming clear: to move from periodic missions toward a more permanent model of care, local capacity building, family support, and disability inclusion on the island.

At the same time, 2024 showed that before such a centre could become reality, HwH would need stronger fundraising, communication, governance, safeguarding, and operational systems. Growth was possible, but it had to be built responsibly.

15

What We Need

PRIORITY NEED: LONG-TERM FINANCIAL PARTNERS

In 2024, HwH showed that its field impact was far greater than its funding structure. The Foundation needs long-term financial partners who understand that sustainable disability care requires planning, continuity, communication, compliance, coordination, travel, and professional support - not only direct treatment days.

- Long-term financial partners to stabilise mission planning and reduce fragile founder-led pressure.
- Communication and donor engagement capacity to transform field work into public awareness and sustainable support.
- Ukraine and REpower rehabilitation support for soldiers, combat medics, and children affected by war.
- Volunteer recruitment and travel support, especially when international flights make participation difficult.
- Support for Bali and the roadmap toward a future Hands With Heart Centre for Children with Disabilities.
- Dedicated funding for Costa Rica and Bribri/Talamanca access work.

- Operational support for adaptive surfing so recognised healthcare value is matched by real logistical support.

Closing Statement

FINAL MESSAGE

In 2024, Hands With Heart Foundation grew through challenge. The year showed that accumulated experience can become readiness, that disability care must reach the places where pain is most present, and that meaningful growth requires stronger systems, stronger partners, and the courage to keep showing up.

Source Notes and Publication Safeguards

Financial sources used

- Spanish association annual accounts / Memoria PYMESFL 2024 + CCAA.
- Hands With Heart Foundation Form 990-EZ 2024.

Impact data sources

- Mission records and internal data provided by HwH during preparation of this report.
- Beneficiary/session distinction based on the 2024 mission activity table provided by HwH.
- Replacement-value methodology developed internally for annual reporting consistency.
- Capacity-building valuation uses a conservative public count of 50 participants, although internal records identified 71 local participants connected to capacity-building activities.

Publication safeguards before upload

- Use only photos and video stills with appropriate consent, especially for children, people with disabilities, Ukrainian beneficiaries, combat medics, and adaptive surfers.
- Avoid identifying vulnerable beneficiaries by full name unless explicit consent exists and publication is ethically appropriate.
- Maintain respectful representation: avoid pity-based imagery and prioritise agency, relationship, inclusion, and care.
- Run one final proofread after graphic design to check numbers, captions, headings, and page layout.
- Keep the official financial documents available internally to support transparency questions from donors or institutions.



Annual Report 2024

hello@handswithheartfoundation.org · handswithheartfoundation.org